

User Study

Instructions for Grading. **PLEASE READ CAREFULLY.**

Imagine you are a user chatting with a chatbot service like Gemini, ChatGPT, DeepSeek etc. On each page you will see:

- A question: vague or ambiguous user message.
- Two clarification questions generated by different chatbots (labeled *Answer A* and *Answer B*) – these are follow-up questions the bot asked to better understand the user's intent.

Please rate each answer (answer A and answer B) on the following criteria :-

- **Precision and Focus:** How exactly the clarification question zeroes in on the missing detail or ambiguity in the original prompt. For example, responses providing examples to nudge the user to ask a more detailed question to the model.
- **Immediate Editability:** How easily you can rewrite your original prompt using only this question. For example, responses providing example choices to the user.
- **Contextual Fit:** How well the question aligns with the intent of the original programming task.

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5:**

"1 = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"5 = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

You will see **one Original Question per page**, with both answers visible at the same time.

Please read both answers carefully before rating.

You will complete **10 total evaluations**.

NOTE: The chatbots were forced to stop outputting text after 50 words. As a consequence, there may be some responses that look like they're cut off or incomplete. Kindly grade only the clarification question asked in Answer A and Answer B (ignoring irrelevant text; e.g., non-English like alphabets).

Question 1

I'm stuck on a part of my code.

Answer A: Could you please share a brief description of the code you're working on and what you're trying to achieve?

Apex

Answer B: Could you tell me a little bit about what part of your code you're stuck on, and what the code *should* be doing? Specifically, what's causing you trouble? (e.g., syntax errors, logic errors,

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5

Question 2

Can someone explain how to optimize my code?

Answer A: Okay, let's clarify. To help you optimize your code effectively, could you tell me:

******What language are you using for your code, and what specific part of it are you finding slow or inefficient? (e.g., loops

Answer B: Okay, here's my question to better understand your prompt:

What kind of code are you working with? (e.g., Python, JavaScript, C++, etc.)

Knowing the language and the type of code you're

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 3

JavaScript

```
function sendRequest(url) {  
  
    const xhr = new XMLHttpRequest();  
  
    xhr.open('GET', url);  
  
    // TODO: Add onload handler  
  
}
```

Answer A: What is the intended purpose of the function `sendRequest` within the context of web development? Specifically, what action or data are you hoping to send to the URL specified in the function?

Johnathan.

Answer B: What is the purpose of this `sendRequest` function? (e.g., is it intended to send a request to a server, fetch data, etc.?)

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5

Question 4

Python

```
import numpy as np

def compute_mean(data):

    return np.mean(data)

# Missing data check

print(compute_mean())
```

Answer A: What kind of data is being provided as input to the `compute_mean` function? (e.g., a list of numbers, a NumPy array, etc.)

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Answer B: Okay, let's clarify what you're trying to achieve with this code snippet. The code snippet appears to be a simple function designed to calculate the mean of a list of numbers. However, it's missing the crucial part – **

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):3

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 5

I need guidance on a library.

Answer A: Okay, to help me guide you effectively, could you tell me what kind of library are you looking for? (e.g., public library, university library, local history library, etc.) allows me to tailor my response

Answer B: Okay, let's figure out the best way to approach this. To help me understand your needs, could you tell me:

- **What kind of library are you looking for?** (e.g., public library, school library

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):3

Immediate Editability (1-5):3

Contextual Fit (1-5):3

Question 6

I'm having trouble with my function.

Answer A: Okay, let's break down the problem. To help me understand what's going wrong and how to fix it, could you tell me:

1. **What language/programming language are you using for your function?** (e

Answer B: Okay, I understand you're having trouble with your function.

Could you please describe the function itself and what you're trying to achieve with it?

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5

Question 7

Python

```
def calculate_area(radius):  
  
    return 3.14 * radius ** 2  
  
# TODO: Handle negative radius  
  
area = calculate_area(-5)
```

Answer A: Okay, let's clarify the purpose of the code and the desired behavior. Could you tell me what the intended use of the `calculate_area` function is? For example, what type of area are you trying to calculate (e

Answer B: What is the expected behavior when a negative radius is provided as input to the `calculate_area` function? 做到

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5

Question 8

Python

```
from flask import Flask

app = Flask(__name__)

@app.route('/')

# TODO: Add a view function


def main():

    return 'Hello World'
```

Answer A: What specific functionality or purpose are you hoping this Flask app will serve? For example, do you want to handle user input, interact with a database, or something else entirely? Knowing the intended interaction with the user or data will help me refine the

Answer B: What is the intended purpose of this Flask application? (e.g., a simple website, a web service, etc.)

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):3

Question 9

Python

```
class User:

    def __init__(self, name, age):

        self.name = name

        self.age = age

user = User('Alice', ) # TODO: specify age
```

Answer A: What age should the `User` object have initially, and what's the intended purpose of the age attribute in this class?

John!

Specifically, are you intending to store the age as an integer, or is there a reason you

Answer B: What is the intended purpose of this code snippet? (e.g., is it meant to create a user object, or something else?)

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 10

Python

```
while True:

    print('Running...')

    if not condition:

        break  // TODO: Define condition
```

Answer A: What is the intended purpose of the code snippet? (e.g., is it a loop, a conditional statement, a game loop, etc.?)
interior Scientistsancake

Answer B: What is the purpose of the code snippet you're referring to? What condition is being checked within the `if not condition` block?
John.

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5